Persist Week of February 16, 2026

REMINDER: Persist is no longer accessible through ATOM. To continue using Persist, you must log in through our new app. If you have not received your login instructions or are experiencing any issues, please contact us at **support@functional-bodybuilding.com**

We will continue to send a PDF version of training in our Persist only weekly newsletters.
This document may be created in advance of edits to the ongoing tracks in Persist, so while we try to minimize these discrepancies as much as possible, the version displayed in our app is always the most up to date. As always, please reach out using the chat bubble in our FBB app or on our website at https://functional-bodybuilding.com if you have any questions about the programming. It may be helpful to look over the week ahead to make sure your questions are all answered in time for your workout.

Pump Lift 5x
- Monday February 16, 2026
- Tuesday February 17, 2026
- Wednesday February 18, 2026
- Thursday February 19, 2026
- Friday February 20, 2026
- Saturday February 21, 2026
- Sunday February 22, 2026

Pump Lift 4x
- Monday February 16, 2026
- Tuesday February 17, 2026
- Wednesday February 18, 2026
- Thursday February 19, 2026
- Friday February 20, 2026
- Saturday February 21, 2026
- Sunday February 22, 2026

Pump Lift 3x
- Monday February 16, 2026
- Tuesday February 17, 2026
- Wednesday February 18, 2026
- Thursday February 19, 2026
- Friday February 20, 2026
- Saturday February 21, 2026
- Sunday February 22, 2026

Pump Condition 5x

- Monday February 16, 2026
- Tuesday February 17, 2026
- Wednesday February 18, 2026
- Thursday February 19, 2026
- Friday February 20, 2026
- Saturday February 21, 2026
- Sunday February 22, 2026

Pump Condition 4x
- Monday February 16, 2026
- Tuesday February 17, 2026
- Wednesday February 18, 2026
- Thursday February 19, 2026
- Friday February 20, 2026
- Saturday February 21, 2026
- Sunday February 22, 2026

Pump Condition 3x
- Monday February 16, 2026
- Tuesday February 17, 2026
- Wednesday February 18, 2026
- Thursday February 19, 2026
- Friday February 20, 2026
- Saturday February 21, 2026
- Sunday February 22, 2026

Perform
- Monday February 16, 2026
- Tuesday February 17, 2026
- Wednesday February 18, 2026
- Thursday February 19, 2026
- Friday February 20, 2026
- Saturday February 21, 2026
- Sunday February 22, 2026

Minimalist
- Monday February 16, 2026
- Tuesday February 17, 2026
- Wednesday February 18, 2026
- Thursday February 19, 2026
- Friday February 20, 2026

Saturday February 21, 2026
Sunday February 22, 2026

Pump Lift 5x

Monday February 16, 2026

Week 2 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Split Stance Deadlift Technique
First, set up in a position with the majority of your weight on the front leg (using your back leg to help balance). As you start to hinge, shift your entire bodyweight into the hip of the front leg. When you lower the bar, lead with your glutes, not your upper back.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warm Up (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Dual DB Sumo Deadlift High Pull; 8 reps
DB Meadows Row; 12 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Split Stance Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
The goal of the split stance deadlift is to develop single-leg strength in the hinge pattern. Be mindful of your weight selection because although you will be pushing with primarily one leg at a time, the lower back will have to be able to tolerate all reps. The rep scheme is structured for an increase in weight each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Pronated Strict Pull Up
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 5 reps @21X0 - RPE 8

Set 2: 3 reps @21X0 - RPE 8
Set 3: 2 reps @21X0 - RPE 8
Set 4: 5 reps @21X0 - RPE 9
Set 5: 3 reps @21X0 - RPE 9
Set 6: 2 reps @21X0 - RPE 9

Loading Note:
As reps go down, make your pull-ups harder by adding weight or using less assistance. The goal of this session is to work on heavy/challenging Pull Ups. The first three sets should be lighter or easier than the last three sets.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
DB Frog Pump; 20-30 reps @10X0
rest 60 sec
DB Gorilla Row; 8 reps/side @21X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set of each movement to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7 on the first working set, and then increase weight each set, building up to RPE 9-10 on your last set.

F) Finisher (8 min):
2-3 Mechanical Drop Sets
DB Twist Curl; 8-10 reps @20X1
rest 10 sec
DB Hammer Curl; 8-10 reps @20X1
rest 2-3 min between sets

Loading Note:
A mechanical drop set is a training technique in which one set is performed with one weight and multiple position changes. Each position change should get more mechanically advantageous.
If you were doing each of these exercises in isolation, the twist curl would be the lightest, and the regular Hammer Curl would be the heaviest. This is why the order of the exercises is written as it is. This creates a mechanical drop set.

G) Cooldown (5 min)
1-2 sets
Pike Stretch; 30-60 sec
Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec
Dynamic Pigeon on Hands and Knees; 3 reps/side with 5 sec stretch.

Tuesday February 17, 2026

Week 2 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Bench Press Variety
Your shoulders are very complex, and are capable of A LOT of different movements and positions. The traditional DB Bench Press is a great exercise for the shoulders, but the variations in this training block respect the unique demands placed on the shoulders.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Arm Bar Rotation; 5 reps/side
Banded YTW; 5-7 reps in each position

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Seated Filly Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Alternating DB Bench Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES - Drop back to same weight as Set 1)

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets

KB Horn Grip Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0
rest 30-60 sec
Offset Kettlebell Push Up; 5-8 reps/side @20X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
3 Cluster Sets
DB Skullcrusher; 5.5.5 @30X0
rest 90 secs between sets
Loading Note:
Select a weight that you can perform for a max set of about 10 reps. The cluster set will allow you to perform 15 reps with short 10-second breaks between each mini-set of 5 reps.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shoulder Extension Bridge; 5-10 reps
Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday February 18, 2026

Week 2 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Complementary Exercises
A lot of exercises are programmed to work nicely alongside a previous exercise. The Hip Thrust in Strength Intensity 2 today serves exactly that purpose. You'll spend a lot of time in the bottom position of the squat in Strength Intensity 1, and then do the exact opposite motion in Strength Intensity 2 with the Hip Thrust.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min)
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Foot Elevated Cossack Squat; 5-7 reps/side
Lateral Banded Walk; 10 steps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
1 1/4 Back Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Control the first descent, come up 1/4 of the way, then control back down into the bottom using a subtle bounce to accelerate all the way back to the top. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
B Stance Hip Thrust
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
The B Stance Hip Thrust places more load on one leg at a time allowing for isolation on each side.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Hand Supported Suitcase KOT Split Squat; 6 reps/side @21X1
rest 30-60 sec
Bodyweight Donkey Calf Raise; 20-30 reps @10X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Perform the KOT (Knee Over Toe) Split Squat for quality not load. This exercise is a great expression of full range of motion in the lower body. Use it to continue to improve your flexibility. Aim for close to failure with each set of calf raises.

F) Finisher (4-8 min):
Feet Anchored Sit Ups
8 sets
20 sec on; 10 sec
Loading Note:

Perform as many reps during the 20 seconds on. Take a 10-second break, then continue to perform as many reps as possible during the next block of 20 seconds. Continue for all sets. Track total reps and attempt to improve this score in week 5.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Butterfly Stretch; 30 sec

Thursday February 19, 2026

Week 2 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run/Bike/Row @ 75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 10 sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 10 reps/side (slow and controlled)
30 sec Superman Hold
Then 30 sec Run/Bike/Row @ 75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 10 sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 10 reps/side (slow and controlled)
15 L Crunches
Then 30 sec Run/Bike/Row @ 75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 10 sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Spine and Posterior Chain
Cat Cow or Segmented Cat Cow x 5 reps
Shinbox ER Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
Jefferson Curl x 3-5 reps
Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
Pike Stretch to Back Roll x 5 reps
Bodyweight RDL x 10 reps

Friday February 20, 2026

Week 2 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Bodyweight Movements
People usually sleep on the Ring Row as a back and biceps builder - but not us. This exercise allows you to get high levels of muscle tension in the back, and forces your core to work hard too. Really focus on squeezing the muscles when doing these, not simply checking the box.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Inchworm Push Up; 6-8 reps
Ring Row Hold; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Floor Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 9 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 20X1 - Harder
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8-9
Working Set 2 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 6 @ 20X1
Working Set 3 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 9 @ 20X1
Working Set 4 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform MAX reps
Loading Note:
The rep scheme is written as a full pyramid when including the warmup sets. Each set should be challenging, aiming for RPE 8-9. Working Set 1 should increase your potential to execute even better on working sets 2-4. Aim for a 5-10% decrease in weight with each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
3 sets
Strict Bar Dip or Ring Dip; 5-7 reps @32X1
rest 15 sec
Pronated Grip Ring Row; 10-20 reps @20X0
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:

Perform a few dip warmup sets to determine weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Curl; 10 reps @20X0
rest 30 sec
DB Overhead Tricep Extension; 10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Incline DB Front Raise; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 15 sec
Incline Rear Delt Swing; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
Straight Arm Shoulder Rotations; 10 reps/side
Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday February 21, 2026

Week 2 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: DB Positioning
Every time you change your dumbbell position for a squat, lunge, or hinge, you impact the muscles that support the pelvis. Notice how these small position changes feel in your hips as you naturally brace to support each movement.
Short on Time? Perform 2 sets of Strength Intensity 1.

B) Warmup (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
+

3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Long Step Walking Lunge; 6-8 reps/side
Russian KBS; 10-15 reps

C) Strength Intensity Giant Set (18 min):
4 sets
DB Zercher Goodmorning; 6-8 reps @30X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Single Arm DB Rack Cyclist Squat; 5-7 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Single Arm Suitcase Reverse Lunge; 8-10 reps/side
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one DB for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Rower, Ring, or Physioball Hamstring Curl; 10-15 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
Band Assisted Reverse Nordics; 8-12 reps @30X0
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For the Hamstring Curl variation, use whichever implement you have access to or feels the best to you. Aim for each set to be challenging and feel good on the targeted areas (hamstrings/knees).

E) Finisher (6-8 min):
Hanging Knee Tuck or Tuck Up; Perform 50 reps in as few sets as possible. Each time you need to break, perform 10 Lateral Banded Walk/side.
Loading Note:
Select the exercise variation that is going to challenge you, but feels attainable.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Heel Sits; 10 reps
Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side

Middle Split; 30 sec

Sunday February 22, 2026

Week 2 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

Overthinking Protein

I got a question recently about protein from someone who was way overthinking it. And they're probably not alone. Whether it's feeding windows, fear of stressing our kidneys, or debates about optimal protein sources, it's easy to second guess everything we do for our nutrition.

When people struggle with nutrition, it's rarely because of lack of information. It's usually because they're complicating things too much. Simple is strong! And very repeatable.

So when it comes to protein, hit a couple basic points on repeat before you stress about anything else. Get some early in the day so you reap the benefits of stable energy, calmed-down cravings, and feeling fuller. And hit your target overall.

If you need to put some numbers on that, shoot for 50g before 10am (or ⅓ your bodyweight in grams), and a total of your bodyweight (in pounds) in grams each day.

Get that consistent before worrying about anything else.

With love,
Marcus

Pump Lift 4x

Monday February 16, 2026

Week 2 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
Daily Focus Notes: Bench Press Variety
Your shoulders are very complex, and are capable of A LOT of different movements and positions. The traditional DB Bench Press is a great exercise for the shoulders, but the variations in this training block respect the unique demands placed on the shoulders.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance
Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice

+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Arm Bar Rotation; 5 reps/side
Banded YTW; 5-7 reps in each position
Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Seated Filly Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Alternating DB Bench Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES - Drop back to same weight as Set 1)
Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
KB Horn Grip Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0
rest 30-60 sec
Offset Kettlebell Push up; 5-8 reps/side @20X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.
Finisher (6-8 min):
3 Cluster Sets
DB Skullcrusher; 5.5.5 @30X0
rest 90 secs between sets
Loading Note:
Select a weight that you can perform for a max set of about 10 reps. The cluster set will allow you to perform 15 reps with short 10-second breaks between each mini-set of 5 reps.
Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets

Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shoulder Extension Bridge; 5-10 reps
Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Tuesday February 17, 2026

Week 2 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
Daily Focus Notes: Split Stance Deadlift Technique
First, set up in a position with the majority of your weight on the front leg (using your back leg to help balance). As you start to hinge, shift your entire bodyweight into the hip of the front leg. When you lower the bar, lead with your glutes, not your upper back.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.
Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Long Step Walking Lunge; 6-8 reps/side
Russian KBS; 10-15 reps
Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Split Stance Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
The goal of the split stance deadlift is to develop single-leg strength in the hinge pattern. Be mindful of your weight selection because although you will be pushing with primarily one leg at a time, the lower back will have to be able to tolerate all reps. The rep scheme is structured for an increase in weight each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Pronated Strict pull up
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 5 reps @21X0 - RPE 8
Set 2: 3 reps @21X0 - RPE 8
Set 3: 2 reps @21X0 - RPE 8
Set 4: 5 reps @21X0 - RPE 9
Set 5: 3 reps @21X0 - RPE 9
Set 6: 2 reps @21X0 - RPE 9

Loading Note:
As reps go down, make your pull-ups harder by adding weight or using less assistance. The goal of this session is to work on heavy/challenging pull ups. The first three sets should be lighter or easier than the last three sets.
Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Single Arm DB Rack Cyclist Squat; 5-7 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Single Arm Suitcase Reverse Lunge; 8-10 reps/side
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body superset, the goal is to use one DB for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE.
Finisher (6-8 min):
Hanging Knee Tuck or Tuck Up; Perform 50 reps in as few sets as possible. Each time you need to break, perform 10 Lateral Banded Walk/side.
Loading Note:
Select the exercise variation that is going to challenge you, but feels attainable.
Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Heel Sits; 10 reps
Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Middle Split; 30 sec

Wednesday February 18, 2026

Week 2 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it. Or try a 30/30 Cardio workout in the Additional Resources section of the app.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Spine and Posterior Chain
Cat Cow or Segmented Cat Cow x 5 reps
Shinbox ER Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
Jefferson Curl x 3-5 reps
Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side

Pike Stretch to Back Roll x 5 reps
Bodyweight RDL x 10 reps

Thursday February 19, 2026

Week 2 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
Daily Focus Notes: Bodyweight Movements
People usually sleep on the Ring Row as a back and biceps builder - but not us. This exercise allows you to get high levels of muscle tension in the back, and forces your core to work hard too. Really focus on squeezing the muscles when doing these, not simply checking the box.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.
Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Inchworm Push up; 6-8 reps
Ring Row Hold; 30 sec
Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Floor Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 9 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 20X1 - Harder
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8-9
Working Set 2 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 6 @ 20X1
Working Set 3 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 9 @ 20X1
Working Set 4 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform MAX reps
Loading Note:
The rep scheme is written as a full pyramid when including the warmup sets. Each set should be challenging, aiming for RPE 8-9. Working Set 1 should increase your potential to execute even better on working sets 2-4. Aim for a 5-10% decrease in weight with each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Strength Intensity 2 (10 min):
3 sets
Strict Bar Dip or Ring Dip; 5-7 reps @32X1
rest 15 sec
Pronated Grip Ring Row; 10-20 reps @20X0
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:

Perform a few dip warmup sets to determine weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder.
Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Curl; 10 reps @20X0
rest 30 sec
DB Overhead Tricep Extension; 10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.
Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Incline DB Front Raise; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 15 sec
Incline Rear Delt Swing; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.
Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
Straight Arm Shoulder Rotations; 10 reps/side
Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side

Friday February 20, 2026

Week 2 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
Daily Focus Notes: Complementary Exercises
A lot of exercises are programmed to work nicely alongside a previous exercise. The Hip Thrust in Strength Intensity 2 today serves exactly that purpose. You'll spend a lot of time in the bottom position of the squat in Strength Intensity 1, and then do the exact opposite motion in Strength Intensity 2 with the Hip Thrust.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.
Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Foot Elevated Cossack Squat; 5-7 reps/side
Lateral Banded Walk; 10 steps/side
Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
1 1/4 Back Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

Control the first descent, come up 1/4 of the way, then control back down into the bottom using a subtle bounce to accelerate all the way back to the top. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
B Stance Hip Thrust
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

The B Stance Hip Thrust places more load on one leg at a time allowing for isolation on each side.

Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Hand Supported Suitcase KOT Split Squat; 6 reps/side @21X1
rest 30-60 sec
Bodyweight Donkey Calf Raise; 20-30 reps @10X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Perform the KOT (Knee Over Toe) Split Squat for quality not load. This exercise is a great expression of full range of motion in the lower body. Use it to continue to improve your flexibility. Aim for close to failure with each set of calf raises.

Finisher (4-8 min):
Feet Anchored Sit Ups
8 sets
20 sec on; 10 sec

Loading Note:

Perform as many reps during the 20 seconds on. Take a 10-second break, then continue to perform as many reps as possible during the next block of 20 seconds. Continue for all sets. Track total reps and attempt to improve this score in week 5.

Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets

Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Butterfly Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday February 21, 2026

Week 2 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run/Bike/Row @ 75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 10 sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 10 reps/side (slow and controlled)
30 sec Superman Hold
Then 30 sec Run/Bike/Row @ 75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 10 sets
2-3 Sets for Quality
Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 10 reps/side (slow and controlled)
15 L Crunches
Then 30 sec Run/Bike/Row @ 75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 10 sets
PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-20 min):
Upper Body Mobility
Shoulder Circles x 10 reps/direction
Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 1 min/side
Childs Pose Reach Through x 1 min/side
Kneeling Triceps Stretch x 30 sec/side
Behind the Back Neck Stretch x 30 sec/side
Prone I x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone T x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone Y x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 3 reps
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Downdog to Updog x 5 reps

Sunday February 22, 2026

Week 2 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

Overthinking Protein

I got a question recently about protein from someone who was way overthinking it. And they're probably not alone. Whether it's feeding windows, fear of stressing our kidneys, or debates about optimal protein sources, it's easy to second guess everything we do for our nutrition.

When people struggle with nutrition, it's rarely because of lack of information. It's usually because they're complicating things too much. Simple is strong! And very repeatable.

So when it comes to protein, hit a couple basic points on repeat before you stress about anything else. Get some early in the day so you reap the benefits of stable energy, calmed-down cravings, and feeling fuller. And hit your target overall.

If you need to put some numbers on that, shoot for 50g before 10am (or ⅓ your bodyweight in grams), and a total of your bodyweight (in pounds) in grams each day.

Get that consistent before worrying about anything else.

With love,
Marcus

Pump Lift 3x

Monday February 16, 2026

Week 2 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Split Stance Deadlift Technique
First, set up in a position with the majority of your weight on the front leg (using your back leg to help balance). As you start to hinge, shift your entire bodyweight into the hip of the front leg. When you lower the bar, lead with your glutes, not your upper back.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice

+
3 Sets
Dual DB Sumo Deadlift High Pull; 8 reps
DB Meadows Row; 12 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Split Stance Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
The goal of the split stance deadlift is to develop single-leg strength in the hinge pattern. Be mindful of your weight selection because although you will be pushing with primarily one leg at a time, the lower back will have to be able to tolerate all reps. The rep scheme is structured for an increase in weight each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
Seated Filly Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Single Arm DB Rack Cyclist Squat; 5-7 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Single Arm Suitcase Reverse Lunge; 8-10 reps/side
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body superset, the goal is to use one DB for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE.

F) Finisher (4-8 min):
Feet Anchored Sit Ups
8 sets
20 sec on; 10 sec
Loading Note:
Perform as many reps during the 20 seconds on. Take a 10-second break, then continue to perform as many reps as possible during the next block of 20 seconds. Continue for all sets. Track total reps and attempt to improve this score in week 5.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pike Stretch; 30-60 sec
Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec
Dynamic Pigeon on Hands and Knees; 3 reps/side with 5 sec stretch.

Tuesday February 17, 2026

Week 2 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Spine and Posterior Chain
Cat Cow or Segmented Cat Cow x 5 reps
Shinbox ER Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
Jefferson Curl x 3-5 reps
Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
Pike Stretch to Back Roll x 5 reps
Bodyweight RDL x 10 reps

Wednesday February 18, 2026

Week 2 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: B Stance Hip Thrust
This exercise needs your attention so that you don't compensate by using the bottom supporting leg or overarching the low back. Try to avoid these faults so you can keep the tension on the glutes. Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Inchworm Push up; 6-8 reps
Ring Row Hold; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Floor Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 9 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 20X1 - Harder
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8-9
Working Set 2 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 6 @ 20X1
Working Set 3 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 9 @ 20X1
Working Set 4 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform MAX reps
Loading Note:
The rep scheme is written as a full pyramid when including the warmup sets. Each set should be challenging, aiming for RPE 8-9. Working Set 1 should increase your potential to execute even better on working sets 2-4. Aim for a 5-10% decrease in weight with each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
B Stance Hip Thrust
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
The B Stance Hip Thrust places more load on one leg at a time allowing for isolation on each side.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Curl; 10 reps @20X0
rest 30 sec
DB Overhead Tricep Extension; 10 reps @20X0

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Incline DB Front Raise; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 15 sec
Incline Rear Delt Swing; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
Butterfly Stretch; 60 sec
Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Thursday February 19, 2026

Week 2 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-20 min):
Upper Body Mobility
Shoulder Circles x 10 reps/direction
Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 1 min/side
Childs Pose Reach Through x 1 min/side
Kneeling Triceps Stretch x 30 sec/side
Behind the Back Neck Stretch x 30 sec/side
Prone I x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone T x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone Y x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 3 reps
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min

Downdog to Updog x 5 reps

Friday February 20, 2026

Week 2 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Bodyweight Pulling
Tension is one of the main terms used when people talk about muscle growth - for good reason. The efficacy of bodyweight movements can be drastically changed by creating more internal tension. Squeeze the muscles of your back and your biceps to get the most out of every ring row rep. Focus less on completing the set and more on the execution of every rep.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Foot Elevated Cossack Squat; 5-7 reps/side
Lateral Banded Walk; 10 steps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
1 1/4 Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Control the first descent, come up 1/4 of the way, then control back down into the bottom using a subtle bounce to accelerate all the way back to the top. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Pronated Strict pull up
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 5 reps @21X0 - RPE 8
Set 2: 3 reps @21X0 - RPE 8
Set 3: 2 reps @21X0 - RPE 8
Set 4: 5 reps @21X0 - RPE 9
Set 5: 3 reps @21X0 - RPE 9

Set 6: 2 reps @21X0 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

As reps go down, make your pull-ups harder by adding weight or using less assistance. The goal of this session is to work on heavy/challenging pull ups. The first three sets should be lighter or easier than the last three sets.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Strict Bar Dip or Ring Dip; 5-7 reps @32X1
rest 15 sec
Pronated Grip Ring Row; 10-20 reps @20X0
rest 2 min and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform a few dip warmup sets to determine weight. Note the dip tempo is 3 seconds down and 2 seconds in the bottom position. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
Hanging Knee Tuck or Tuck Up; Perform 50 reps in as few sets as possible. Each time you need to break, perform 10 Lateral Banded Walk/side.

Loading Note:

Select the exercise variation that is going to challenge you, but feels attainable.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Shoulder Extension Bridge; 10 reps

Saturday February 21, 2026

Week 2 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run/Bike/Row @ 75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 10 sets
2-3 Sets for Quality
Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 10 reps/side (slow and controlled)
30 sec Superman Hold

30 sec Run/Bike/Row @ 75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 10 sets
2-3 Sets for Quality
Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 10 reps/side (slow and controlled)
15 L Crunches
30 sec Run/Bike/Row @ 75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 10 sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Shoulder Flexion
Passive Hang x 1 min
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side with 5 sec hold
PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 reps with 3 sec hold
Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10 reps
Prone Shoulder Swimmers (Blackburns) x 5 reps

Sunday February 22, 2026

Week 2 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

Overthinking Protein

I got a question recently about protein from someone who was way overthinking it. And they're probably not alone. Whether it's feeding windows, fear of stressing our kidneys, or debates about optimal protein sources, it's easy to second guess everything we do for our nutrition.

When people struggle with nutrition, it's rarely because of lack of information. It's usually because they're complicating things too much. Simple is strong! And very repeatable.

So when it comes to protein, hit a couple basic points on repeat before you stress about anything else. Get some early in the day so you reap the benefits of stable energy, calmed-down cravings, and feeling fuller. And hit your target overall.

If you need to put some numbers on that, shoot for 50g before 10am (or ⅓ your bodyweight in grams), and a total of your bodyweight (in pounds) in grams each day.

Get that consistent before worrying about anything else.

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 5x

Monday February 16, 2026

Week 2 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Pull Up Negative Benefits
Tension is one of the main terms used when people talk about muscle growth - for good reason. And using weights to overload your Pull Up negatives leads to exactly this - HIGH MUSCLE TENSION. Fight to go slowly down during each negative, and feel the high muscular tension in the biceps and lats.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Dual DB Sumo Deadlift High Pull; 8 reps
DB Meadows Row; 12 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Split Stance Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
The goal of the split stance deadlift is to develop single-leg strength in the hinge pattern. Be mindful of your weight selection because although you will be pushing with primarily one leg at a time, the lower back will have to be able to tolerate all reps. The rep scheme is structured for an increase in weight each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets:
DB Frog Pump; 20-30 reps @10X0
rest 30-60 sec
Pronated Pull Up Negatives; 3 reps @51A1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
For the Pull Up Negative, the tempo is a 1 sec pause at the top and bottom with 5 second negative. Make sure that you have a box or bench near the Pull Up bar, so you can step or jump back up to the top position (A = Assist). The goal is to overload with more weight than you can normally do a Pull Up with. For some this may be just bodyweight, and for others you may have to add up to half your bodyweight.

E) Pull and Core Conditioning (12-15 min):
2 Sets
For Time
500/400m Row (male/female)
-60sec rest-
4 rounds for time:
10 Dumbbell Pendlay Row 50/35# or 35/25#
40 Double Unders or 60 Single Unders
-60-second rest and then repeat from the beginning for a second set-
Effort Note:
Perform the first set at a sustainable pace. The second set should be close to consistent speed as the first set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pike Stretch; 30-60 sec
Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec
Dynamic Pigeon on Hands and Knees; 3 reps/side with 5 sec stretch.

Tuesday February 17, 2026

Week 2 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Bench Press Variety
Your shoulders are very complex, and are capable of A LOT of different movements and positions. The traditional DB Bench Press is a great exercise for the shoulders, but the variations in this training block respect the unique demands placed on the shoulders.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Arm Bar Rotation; 5 reps/side
Banded YTW; 5-7 reps in each position

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Seated Filly Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
KB Horn Grip Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0
rest 30-60 sec
Offset Kettlebell Push up; 5-8 reps/side @20X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Upper Body Grinder (15 min time cap):
15-12-10-8-6
Single Arm DB Bench Press/side
Burpee Over DB Laterally
*20m Left Side Single Arm Farmers Walk (70/53# or 53/35#) (male/female)
Effort Note:
Select a weight that you can perform for multiple sets of 15 reps. The order of this workout is as follows:
15 R arm DB Bench Press, 15 L arm DB Bench Press, 15 Burpee, 20m/side Single Arm Farmers Walk.
12 R arm DB Bench Press...

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shoulder Extension Bridge; 5-10 reps
Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday February 18, 2026

Week 2 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Complementary Exercises
A lot of exercises are programmed to work nicely alongside a previous exercise. The Hip Thrust today serves exactly that purpose. You'll spend a lot of time in the bottom position of the squat in Strength Intensity 1, and then do the exact opposite motion in Strength Intensity 2 with the Hip Thrust.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Foot Elevated Cossack Squat; 5-7 reps/side
Lateral Banded Walk; 10 steps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Control the first descent, come up 1/4 of the way, then control back down into the bottom using a subtle bounce to accelerate all the way back to the top. Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1 1/4 Barbell Hip Thrust; 10 reps
rest 30-60 sec

Bodyweight Donkey Calf Raise; 20-30 reps @10X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set for each movement to determine the starting weight. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7 and then increase weight each set.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12-15 min):
3 Sets @ high effort
8 Single Arm KB Snatch Right 53/35# (male/female)
8 Single Arm KB Snatch Left 53/35#
6/leg Single Arm KB Front Rack Box Step Up 53/35#, 16-20"
15-20 Cal Row
rest 90sec between sets
Effort Note:
The suggested loads are only here as a reference point. I want you to be able to move smoothly through all your weight reps without having to take breaks or slow down. If that means you need to lighten up your weight, then please do so.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Butterfly Stretch; 30 sec

Thursday February 19, 2026

Week 2 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run/Bike/Row @ 75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 10 sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 10 reps/side (slow and controlled)
30 sec Superman Hold
Then 30 sec Run/Bike/Row @ 75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 10 sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 10 reps/side (slow and controlled)

15 L Crunches
Then 30 sec Run/Bike/Row @ 75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 10 sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Spine and Posterior Chain
Cat Cow or Segmented Cat Cow x 5 reps
Shinbox ER Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
Jefferson Curl x 3-5 reps
Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
Pike Stretch to Back Roll x 5 reps
Bodyweight RDL x 10 reps

Friday February 20, 2026

Week 2 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Functional Arms
The strength balance today focuses on the arms, which are often viewed as vanity muscles. Although this is true, the biceps and triceps are some of the most commonly used muscles in our day to day behavior. Why not look good and move well?
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Inchworm Pushup; 6-8 reps
Ring Row Hold; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Floor Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 9 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 20X1 - Harder
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8-9
Working Set 2 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 6 @ 20X1
Working Set 3 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 9 @ 20X1

Working Set 4 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform MAX reps

Loading Note:

The rep scheme is written as a full pyramid when including the warmup sets. Each set should be challenging, aiming for RPE 8-9. Working Set 1 should increase your potential to execute even better on working sets 2-4. Aim for a 5-10% decrease in weight with each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Curl; 10 reps @20X0
rest 30 sec
DB Overhead Tricep Extension; 10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Push Pull Sprint (12-15 min):
Every 2mins x 3 Sets
12/9 Row Calories @ high effort (male/female)
10 Dumbbell Glute Bridge Floor Press
Move immediately into the next couplet -
Every 2mins x 3 Sets
12/9 Row Calories @ high effort
10-15 Body Rows
Effort Note:
The goal is to have the work completed around the 1min mark, giving you 1 full minute to rest on each set. If you find your work is taking you significantly longer than 1 minute, then reduce the calories or reps on either movement.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
Straight Arm Shoulder Rotations; 10 reps/side
Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday February 21, 2026

Week 2 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: DB Positioning

Every time you change your dumbbell position for a squat, lunge, or hinge, you impact the muscles that support the pelvis. Notice how these small position changes feel in your hips as you naturally brace to support each movement.
Short on Time? Perform 2 sets of Strength Intensity 1.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Long Step Walking Lunge; 6-8 reps/side
Russian KBS; 10-15 reps

C) Strength Intensity Giant Set (18 min):
4 sets
DB Zercher Goodmorning; 6-8 reps @30X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Single Arm DB Rack Cyclist Squat; 5-7 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Single Arm Suitcase Reverse Lunge; 8-10 reps/side
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one DB for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

D) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
3-4 Sets
Run 200m
rest 15sec
8/side DB Suitcase Curtsy Squat @ 20X0 Tempo - 50/35# or 35/20#
rest 15 sec
16 Weighted Anchored Sit Up (50/35#) (male/female)
rest 15sec
Run 200m
rest walk 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Set 1 - Moderate Pace
Set 2 - Hard Pace

Set 3-4 - Tough Pace - stop after 3 sets if your pace or quality drop off

E) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Heel Sits; 10 reps
Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Middle Split; 30 sec

Sunday February 22, 2026

Week 2 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x
Overthinking Protein

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Get that consistent before worrying about anything else.

With love,

Pump Condition 4x

Monday February 16, 2026

Week 2 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Pull Up Intention

On Pull Ups today, try to focus less on how many reps you are doing and more on the quality of those reps. To keep quality high, focus on initiating the pull with your lats, keeping your shoulder blades down and back, and reaching your chest towards the bar (not your chin). The tempo progression that is built in over the next four weeks will help you to continue to improve the quality of your Pull Ups.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Arm Bar Rotation; 5 reps/side
Banded YTW; 5-7 reps in each position

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Seated Filly Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Supinated Strict Pull Up; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 30 sec
KB Horn Grip Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
Offset Kettlebell Push up; 5-8 reps/side @20X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Upper Body Grinder (15 min time cap):
15-12-10-8-6
Single Arm DB Bench Press/side

Burpee Over DB Laterally
*20m Left Side Single Arm Farmers Walk (70/53# or 53/35#) (male/female)
Effort Note:
Select a weight that you can perform for multiple sets of 15 reps. The order of this workout is as follows:
15 R arm DB Bench Press, 15 L arm DB Bench Press, 15 Burpee, 20m/side Single Arm Farmers Walk.
12 R arm DB Bench Press...

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1) Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
2) Shoulder Extension Bridge; 5-10 reps
3) Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Tuesday February 17, 2026

Week 2 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Split Stance Deadlift Technique
First, set up in a position with the majority of your weight on the front leg (using your back leg to help balance). As you start to hinge, shift your entire bodyweight into the hip of the front leg. When you lower the bar, lead with your glutes, not your upper back.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Dual DB Sumo Deadlift High Pull; 8 reps
DB Meadows Row; 12 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Split Stance Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:

The goal of the split stance deadlift is to develop single-leg strength in the hinge pattern. Be mindful of your weight selection because although you will be pushing with primarily one leg at a time, the lower back will have to be able to tolerate all reps. The rep scheme is structured for an increase in weight each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Single Arm DB Rack Cyclist Squat; 5-7 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Single Arm Suitcase Reverse Lunge; 8-10 reps/side
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body superset, the goal is to use one DB for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE.

E) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
3-4 Sets
Run 200m
rest 15sec
8/side DB Suitcase Curtsy Squat @ 20X0 Tempo - 50/35# or 35/20#
rest 15 sec
16 Weighted Anchored Sit Up (50/35#) (male/female)
rest 15sec
Run 200m
rest walk 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Set 1 - Moderate Pace
Set 2 - Hard Pace
Set 3-4 - Tough Pace - stop after 3 sets if your pace or quality drop off

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Butterfly Stretch; 30 sec

Wednesday February 18, 2026

Week 2 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min): Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Spine and Posterior Chain
Cat Cow or Segmented Cat Cow x 5 reps
Shinbox ER Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
Jefferson Curl x 3-5 reps
Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
Pike Stretch to Back Roll x 5 reps
Bodyweight RDL x 10 reps

Thursday February 19, 2026

Week 2 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Functional Arms
The strength balance today focuses on the arms, which are often viewed as vanity muscles. Although this is true, the biceps and triceps are some of the most commonly used muscles in our day to day behavior. Why not look good and move well?
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Inchworm Pushup; 6-8 reps
Ring Row Hold; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Floor Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 9 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 20X1 - Harder
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8-9
Working Set 2 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 6 @ 20X1
Working Set 3 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 9 @ 20X1

Working Set 4 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform MAX reps

Loading Note:

The rep scheme is written as a full pyramid when including the warmup sets. Each set should be challenging, aiming for RPE 8-9. Working Set 1 should increase your potential to execute even better on working sets 2-4. Aim for a 5-10% decrease in weight with each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Curl; 10 reps @20X0
rest 30 sec
DB Overhead Tricep Extension; 10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Push Pull Sprint (12-15 min):
Every 2mins x 3 Sets
12/9 Row Calories @ high effort (male/female)
10 Strict Bar Dip or Ring Dip @20X0
Move immediately into the next couplet -
Every 2mins x 3 Sets
12/9 Row Calories @ high effort
10-15 Body Rows
Effort Note:
The goal is to have the work completed around the 1min mark, giving you 1 full minute to rest on each set. If you find your work is taking you significantly longer than 1 minute, then reduce the calories or reps on either movement.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
Straight Arm Shoulder Rotations; 10 reps/side
Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side

Friday February 20, 2026

Week 2 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Complementary Exercises

A lot of exercises are programmed to work nicely alongside a previous exercise. The Hip Thrust in Strength Balance today serves exactly that purpose. You'll spend a lot of time in the bottom position of the squat in Strength Intensity 1, and then do the exact opposite motion in Strength Balance with the Hip Thrust.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Long Step Walking Lunge; 6-8 reps/side
Russian KBS; 10-15 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Control the first descent, come up 1/4 of the way, then control back down into the bottom using a subtle bounce to accelerate all the way back to the top. Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1 1/4 Barbell Hip Thrust; 10 reps
rest 30-60 sec
Bodyweight Donkey Calf Raise; 20-30 reps @10X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set for each movement to determine the starting weight. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7 and then increase weight each set.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12-15 min):
3 Sets @ high effort

8 Single Arm KB Snatch Right 53/35# (male/female)
8 Single Arm KB Snatch Left 53/35#
6/leg Single Arm KB Front Rack Box Step Up 53/35#, 16-20"
15-20 Cal Row
rest 90sec between sets
Effort Note:
The suggested loads are only here as a reference point. I want you to be able to move smoothly through all your weight reps without having to take breaks or slow down. If that means you need to lighten up your weight, then please do so.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Heel Sits; 10 reps
Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Middle Split; 30 sec

Saturday February 21, 2026

Week 2 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run/Bike/Row @ 75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 10 sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 10 reps/side (slow and controlled)
30 sec Superman Hold
Then 30 sec Run/Bike/Row @ 75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 10 sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 10 reps/side (slow and controlled)
15 L Crunches
Then 30 sec Run/Bike/Row @ 75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 10 sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-20 min):
Upper Body Mobility
Shoulder Circles x 10 reps/direction

Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 1 min/side
Childs Pose Reach Through x 1 min/side
Kneeling Triceps Stretch x 30 sec/side
Behind the Back Neck Stretch x 30 sec/side
Prone I x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone T x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone Y x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 3 reps
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Downdog to Updog x 5 reps

Sunday February 22, 2026

Week 2 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x
Overthinking Protein

I got a question recently about protein from someone who was way overthinking it. And they're probably not alone. Whether it's feeding windows, fear of stressing our kidneys, or debates about optimal protein sources, it's easy to second guess everything we do for our nutrition.

When people struggle with nutrition, it's rarely because of lack of information. It's usually because they're complicating things too much. Simple is strong! And very repeatable.

So when it comes to protein, hit a couple basic points on repeat before you stress about anything else. Get some early in the day so you reap the benefits of stable energy, calmed-down cravings, and feeling fuller. And hit your target overall.

If you need to put some numbers on that, shoot for 50g before 10am (or ⅓ your bodyweight in grams), and a total of your bodyweight (in pounds) in grams each day.

Get that consistent before worrying about anything else.

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 3x

Monday February 16, 2026

Week 2 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Split Stance Deadlift Technique
First, set up in a position with the majority of your weight on the front leg (using your back leg to help balance). As you start to hinge, shift your entire bodyweight into the hip of the front leg. When you lower the bar, lead with your glutes, not your upper back.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Dual DB Sumo Deadlift High Pull; 8 reps
DB Meadows Row; 12 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Split Stance Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
The goal of the split stance deadlift is to develop single-leg strength in the hinge pattern. Be mindful of your weight selection because although you will be pushing with primarily one leg at a time, the lower back will have to be able to tolerate all reps. The rep scheme is structured for an increase in weight each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Supinated Strict Pull Up; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 30 sec
Seated Filly Press; 6 reps/side @30X0
rest 30 sec
Offset Kettlebell Push up; 5-8 reps/side @20X1

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
3-4 Sets
Run 200m
rest 15sec
8/side DB Suitcase Curtsy Squat @ 20X0 Tempo - 50/35# or 35/20#
rest 15 sec
16 Weighted Anchored Sit Up (50/35#) (male/female)
rest 15sec
Run 200m
rest walk 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Set 1 - Moderate Pace
Set 2 - Hard Pace
Set 3-4 - Tough Pace - stop after 3 sets if your pace or quality drop off

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pike Stretch; 30-60 sec
Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec
Dynamic Pigeon on Hands and Knees; 3 reps/side with 5 sec stretch.

Tuesday February 17, 2026

Week 2 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min): Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Spine and Posterior Chain
Cat Cow or Segmented Cat Cow x 5 reps
Shinbox ER Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
Jefferson Curl x 3-5 reps
Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
Pike Stretch to Back Roll x 5 reps

Bodyweight RDL x 10 reps

Wednesday February 18, 2026

Week 2 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Exercise Variety
One of the benefits of using different types of movements instead of the same exact ones each week is that you can overload different portions of the muscle with small movement variations. The Floor Press and 1 1/4 Bench Press, both of which you'll see in this cycle, are both horizontal barbell presses that strengthen the pecs, but the different range of motion and subtle difference leads to a completely new stimulus for chest, triceps, and shoulders too.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Inchworm Push up; 6-8 reps
Ring Row Hold; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Floor Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 9 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 20X1 - Harder
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8-9
Working Set 2 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 6 @ 20X1
Working Set 3 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 9 @ 20X1
Working Set 4 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform MAX reps
Loading Note:
The rep scheme is written as a full pyramid when including the warmup sets. Each set should be challenging, aiming for RPE 8-9. Working Set 1 should increase your potential to execute even better on working sets 2-4. Aim for a 5-10% decrease in weight with each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Single Arm DB Rack Cyclist Squat; 5-7 reps/side @20X0

rest 30 sec
Single Arm Suitcase Reverse Lunge; 8-10 reps/side
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body superset, the goal is to use one DB for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE.

E) Push Pull Sprint (12-15 min):
Every 2mins x 3 Sets
12/9 Row Calories @ high effort (male/female)
10 Strict Bar Dip or Ring Dip @20X0
Move immediately into the next couplet -
Every 2mins x 3 Sets
12/9 Row Calories @ high effort
10-15 Body Rows
Effort Note:
The goal is to have the work completed around the 1min mark, giving you 1 full minute to rest on each set. If you find your work is taking you significantly longer than 1 minute, then reduce the calories or reps on either movement.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
Butterfly Stretch; 60 sec
Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Thursday February 19, 2026

Week 2 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min): Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-20 min):
Upper Body Mobility
Shoulder Circles x 10 reps/direction
Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 1 min/side
Childs Pose Reach Through x 1 min/side

Kneeling Triceps Stretch x 30 sec/side
Behind the Back Neck Stretch x 30 sec/side
Prone I x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone T x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone Y x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 3 reps
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Downdog to Updog x 5 reps

Friday February 20, 2026

Week 2 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Functional Arms
The strength balance today focuses on the arms, which are often viewed as vanity muscles. Although this is true, the biceps and triceps are some of the most commonly used muscles in our day to day behavior. Why not look good and move well?
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Foot Elevated Cossack Squat; 5-7 reps/side
Lateral Banded Walk; 10 steps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Control the first descent, come up 1/4 of the way, then control back down into the bottom using a subtle bounce to accelerate all the way back to the top. Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):

3 sets
Barbell Curl; 10 reps @20X0
rest 30 sec
DB Overhead Tricep Extension; 10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12-15 min):
3 Sets @ high effort
8 Single Arm KB Snatch Right 53/35# (male/female)
8 Single Arm KB Snatch Left 53/35#
8 Single Arm KB Floor Press Right 53/35#
8 Single Arm KB Floor Press Left 53/35#
15-20 Cal Row
rest 90sec between sets
Effort Note:
The suggested loads are only here as a reference point. I want you to be able to move smoothly through all your weight reps without having to take breaks or slow down. If that means you need to lighten up your weight, then please do so.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Shoulder Extension Bridge; 10 reps

Saturday February 21, 2026

Week 2 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run/Bike/Row @ 75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 10 sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 10 reps/side (slow and controlled)
30 sec Superman Hold
Then 30 sec Run/Bike/Row @ 75% effort
rest 30 sec

x 10 sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 10 reps/side (slow and controlled
15 L Crunches
Then 30 sec Run/Bike/Row @ 75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 10 sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Flexion
Passive Hang x 1 min
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side with 5 sec hold
PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 reps with 3 sec hold
Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10 reps
Prone Shoulder Swimmers (Blackburns) x 5 reps

Sunday February 22, 2026

Week 2 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x
Overthinking Protein

I got a question recently about protein from someone who was way overthinking it. And they're probably not alone. Whether it's feeding windows, fear of stressing our kidneys, or debates about optimal protein sources, it's easy to second guess everything we do for our nutrition.

When people struggle with nutrition, it's rarely because of lack of information. It's usually because they're complicating things too much. Simple is strong! And very repeatable.

So when it comes to protein, hit a couple basic points on repeat before you stress about anything else. Get some early in the day so you reap the benefits of stable energy, calmed-down cravings, and feeling fuller. And hit your target overall.

If you need to put some numbers on that, shoot for 50g before 10am (or ⅓ your bodyweight in grams), and a total of your bodyweight (in pounds) in grams each day.

Get that consistent before worrying about anything else.

With love,

Marcus

Perform

Monday February 16, 2026

Week 2 Day 1 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Pull Up Negative Benefits
Tension is one of the main terms used when people talk about muscle growth - for good reason. And using weights to overload your pull up negatives leads to exactly this - HIGH MUSCLE TENSION. Fight to go slowly down during each negative, and feel the high muscular tension in the biceps and lats.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Dual DB Sumo Deadlift High Pull; 8 reps
DB Meadows Row; 12 reps/side

C) HOT START (10-12 minutes):
4 Rounds Increasing Effort:
15/12 Calorie Bike (male/female)
16 Alternating KB Clean from Floor 53/35 or 35/26 - (8/arm)
16 Air Squats
rest 45 sec between rounds
Effort Note:
Round 1 - Moderate
Round 2 - Hard
Round 3-4 - Very Tough Pace

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Split Stance Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

The goal of the split stance deadlift is to develop single-leg strength in the hinge pattern. Be mindful of your weight selection because although you will be pushing with primarily one leg at a time, the lower back will have to be able to tolerate all reps. The rep scheme is structured for an increase in weight each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets:
DB Frog Pump; 20-30 reps @10X0
rest 30-60 sec
Pronated Pull Up Negatives; 3 reps @51A1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

For the Pull Up Negative, the tempo is a 1 sec pause at the top and bottom with 5 second negative. Make sure that you have a box or bench near the pull up bar, so you can step or jump back up to the top position (A = Assist). The goal is to overload with more weight than you can normally do a pull up with. For some this may be just bodyweight, and for others you may have to add up to half your bodyweight.

F) Pull Conditioning (12-15 min):
2 Sets
For Time
500/400m Row (male/female)
-60sec rest-
4 rounds for time:
10 Hang Power Clean (95/75)
30 Double Unders or 50 Single Unders
-60-second rest and then repeat from the beginning for a second set-
Effort Note:
Perform the first set at a sustainable pace. The second set should be close to consistent speed as the first set.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pike Stretch; 30-60 sec
Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec
Dynamic Pigeon on Hands and Knees; 3 reps/side with 5 sec stretch.

Tuesday February 17, 2026

Week 2 Day 2 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Bench Press Variety
Your shoulders are very complex, and are capable of A LOT of different movements and positions. The traditional DB Bench Press is a great exercise for the shoulders, but the variations in the conditioning on this day respect the unique demands placed on the shoulders.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Arm Bar Rotation; 5 reps/side
Banded YTW; 5-7 reps in each position

C) Dip + Core + Shoulder Prefatigue (12 min):
3 Working Sets
Bottom of Dip Support; 20-30 sec
directly into
Dip Support Tuck L Sit; 20-30 sec
rest 15sec
Powell Raise; 10-12 reps/side
rest 90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Increase intensity each set. Start on the lower end of the reps (with less weight on the DB) and then increase weight and reps.

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Seated Filly Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
KB Horn Grip Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0
rest 30-60 sec
Offset Kettlebell Push up; 5-8 reps/side @20X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Upper Body Conditioning (12 min):
12 min AMRAP @80-85% effort (As Many Rounds/Reps As Possible)
4-6-8-10...(add 2 reps each round)
Single Arm Devils Press (50/35#) (male/female)
Pushup
*8/6 Cal Bike between each set.
Effort Note:
Pace both movements from the start. The first few rounds will feel easy, but the intensity will pick up quickly.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shoulder Extension Bridge; 5-10 reps
Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday February 18, 2026

Week 2 Day 3 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Complementary Exercises
A lot of exercises are programmed to work nicely alongside a previous exercise. The Hip Thrust in Strength Balance today serves exactly that purpose. You'll spend a lot of time in the bottom position of the squat in Strength Intensity, and then do the exact opposite motion in Strength Balance with the Hip Thrust.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Foot Elevated Cossack Squat; 5-7 reps/side

Lateral Banded Walk; 10 steps/side

C) Speed Strength - Snatch (15 min):
Barbell Warm-up:
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Snatch Grip Romanian Deadlift
10 BTN Snatch Press or BTN Snatch Push Press
10 Overhead Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Snatch Grip Hold
10 sec Snatch Grip Overhead Hold
10 sec Overhead Squat Hold
+
Every 2:00 x 5 sets
1 Low Hang Snatch High Pull + 1 Low Hang Power Snatch + 1 Hang Power Snatch
rest until the next 2:00
Sets 1-2: Easy
Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Control the first descent, come up 1/4 of the way, then control back down into the bottom using a subtle bounce to accelerate all the way back to the top. Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1 1/4 Barbell Hip Thrust; 10 reps
rest 30-60 sec
Bodyweight Donkey Calf Raise; 20-30 reps @10X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set for each movement to determine the starting weight. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7 and then increase weight each set.

F) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
3-4 Sets
Run 200m
rest 15 sec
8/side DB Suitcase Curtsy Squat @ 20X0 Tempo - 50/35# or 35/20#
rest 15 sec
16 Weighted Anchored Sit Up (50/35#) (male/female)
rest 15 sec
Run 200m
rest walk 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Set 1 - Moderate Pace
Set 2 - Hard Pace
Set 3-4 - Tough Pace - stop after 3 sets if your pace or quality drop off

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Butterfly Stretch; 30 sec

Thursday February 19, 2026

Week 2 Day 4 - Persist PERFORM

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run/Bike/Row @ 75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 10 sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 10 reps/side (slow and controlled)
30 sec Superman Hold
Then 30 sec Run/Bike/Row @ 75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 10 sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 10 reps/side (slow and controlled)

15 L Crunches
Then 30 sec Run/Bike/Row @ 75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 10 sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Spine and Posterior Chain
Cat Cow or Segmented Cat Cow x 5 reps
Shinbox ER Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
Jefferson Curl x 3-5 reps
Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
Pike Stretch to Back Roll x 5 reps
Bodyweight RDL x 10 reps

Friday February 20, 2026

Week 2 Day 5 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Functional Arms
The strength balance today focuses on the arms, which are often viewed as vanity muscles. Although this is true, the biceps and triceps are some of the most commonly used muscles in our day to day behavior. Why not look good and move well?
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Inchworm Pushup; 6-8 reps
Ring Row Hold; 30 sec

C) Gymnastics HOT START (10-12 min):
Every 2:30 x 4-5 sets
1 Rope Climb or 5 Strict Pull Ups
5 Strict Handstand Push Up
1 Rope Climb or 5 Strict Pull Ups
5 Strict Handstand Push Up
10/8 Cal Bike @ HIGH Effort (male/female)
Effort Note:
Adjust pace as needed to prioritize high quality reps on the gymnastics movements.

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Floor Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 9 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 20X1 - Harder
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8-9
Working Set 2 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 6 @ 20X1
Working Set 3 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 9 @ 20X1
Working Set 4 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform MAX reps
Loading Note:
The rep scheme is written as a full pyramid when including the warmup sets. Each set should be challenging, aiming for RPE 8-9. Working Set 1 should increase your potential to execute even better on working sets 2-4. Aim for a 5-10% decrease in weight with each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Curl; 10 reps @20X0
rest 30 sec
DB Overhead Tricep Extension; 10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) GRINDER Conditioning (12 min):
For Time @ Sustainable Pace
750/600m Bike (male/female)
50m KB Rack Carry 53/35# or 35/26#
10 KB Windmill/arm 53/35# or 35/26#
100m KB Rack Carry 53/35# or 35/26#
10 KB Windmill/arm 53/35# or 35/26#
50m KB Rack Carry 53/35# or 35/26#
750/600m Bike
*Time Cap - 12mins
Effort Note:

These conditioning pieces are exploring challenging KB weights and movements like the GetUp and the Windmill over this 6-week cycle. Move at a controlled pace and slow down to make sure you execute the more complex movements correctly.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
Straight Arm Shoulder Rotations; 10 reps/side
Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday February 21, 2026

Week 2 Day 6 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: DB Positioning
Every time you change your dumbbell position for a squat, lunge, or hinge, you impact the muscles that support the pelvis. Notice how these small position changes feel in your hips as you naturally brace to support each movement.
Short on Time? Perform 2 sets of Strength Intensity 1.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Long Step Walking Lunge; 6-8 reps/side
Russian KBS; 10-15 reps

C) Speed Strength - Clean (15 min):
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Romanian Deadlift
10 Strict Press
10 Front Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Clean Grip Hold
10 sec Front Rack Hold
10 sec Front Squat Hold
+
5 sets; rest 90 sec between sets
2 Hang Clean
Sets 1-2: Easy

Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity Giant Set (18 min):
4 sets
DB Zercher Goodmorning; 6-8 reps @30X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Single Arm DB Rack Cyclist Squat; 5-7 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Single Arm Suitcase Reverse Lunge; 8-10 reps/side
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one DB for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

E) Alphabet Soup (20-25 minutes):
4 sets:
A. 12 DB Power Cleans 50/35#
B. 9 DB Box Step Overs 50/35# 20/16"
C. 18/15 Cal Row (male/female)
D. 9 DB Burpee 50/35#
E. 12 DB Thrusters 50/35#
rest walk 2mins
Effort note:
Changing the exercise order each set requires good pacing and a better understanding of the demands of each individual movement. Follow this order:
Set 1 - ABCDE
Set 2 - EDCBA
Set 3 - CDEAB
Set 4 - BAEDC

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Heel Sits; 10 reps
Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Middle Split; 30 sec

Sunday February 22, 2026

Week 2 Day 7 - Persist PERFORM
Overthinking Protein

I got a question recently about protein from someone who was way overthinking it. And they're probably not alone. Whether it's feeding windows, fear of stressing our kidneys, or debates about optimal protein sources, it's easy to second guess everything we do for our nutrition.

When people struggle with nutrition, it's rarely because of lack of information. It's usually because they're complicating things too much. Simple is strong! And very repeatable.

So when it comes to protein, hit a couple basic points on repeat before you stress about anything else. Get some early in the day so you reap the benefits of stable energy, calmed-down cravings, and feeling fuller. And hit your target overall.

If you need to put some numbers on that, shoot for 50g before 10am (or ⅓ your bodyweight in grams), and a total of your bodyweight (in pounds) in grams each day.

Get that consistent before worrying about anything else.

With love,
Marcus

Minimalist

Monday February 16, 2026

Week 2 Day 1 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: Pull Up Intention
On Pull Ups today, try to focus less on how many reps you are doing and more on the quality of those reps. To keep quality high, focus on initiating the pull with your lats, keeping your shoulder blades down and back, and reaching your chest towards the bar (not your chin). The tempo progression that is built in over the next four weeks will help you to continue to improve the quality of your Pull Ups.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Arm Bar Rotation; 5 reps/side
Prone Shoulder Swimmers; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Seated DB Filly Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Supinated Strict Pull Up; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 30 sec
DB Lateral Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
Offset Push up; 5-8 reps/side @20X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Upper Body Grinder (15 min time cap):
15-12-10-8-6
Single Arm DB Bench Press/side
Burpee Over DB Laterally
*20m Left Side Single Arm Farmers Walk (70/53# or 53/35#) (male/female)
Effort Note:
Select a weight that you can perform for multiple sets of 15 reps. The order of this workout is as follows:
15 R arm DB Bench Press, 15 L arm DB Bench Press, 15 Burpee, 20m/side Single Arm Farmers Walk.
12 R arm DB Bench Press...

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Heel Sits; 10 reps
Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Middle Split; 30 sec

Tuesday February 17, 2026

Week 2 Day 2 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: Split Stance Deadlift Technique
First, set up in a position with the majority of your weight on the front leg (using your back leg to help balance). As you start to hinge, shift your entire bodyweight into the hip of the front leg. When you lower the bar, lead with your glutes, not your upper back.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Dual DB Sumo Deadlift High Pull; 8 reps
DB Meadows Row; 12 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
DB Split Stance Romanian Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
The goal of the split stance deadlift is to develop single-leg strength in the hinge pattern. Be mindful of your weight selection because although you will be pushing with primarily one leg at a time, the lower back will have to be able to tolerate all reps. The rep scheme is structured for an increase in weight each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Single Arm DB Rack Cyclist Squat; 5-7 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec

Single Arm Suitcase Reverse Lunge; 8-10 reps/side
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body superset, the goal is to use one DB for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE.

E) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
3-4 Sets
Run 200m
rest 15sec
8/side DB Suitcase Curtsy Squat @ 20X0 Tempo - 50/35# or 35/20#
rest 15 sec
16 Weighted Anchored Sit Up (50/35#) (male/female)
rest 15sec
Run 200m
rest walk 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Set 1 - Moderate Pace
Set 2 - Hard Pace
Set 3-4 - Tough Pace - stop after 3 sets if your pace or quality drop off

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Butterfly Stretch; 30 sec

Wednesday February 18, 2026

Week 2 Day 3 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min): Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Spine and Posterior Chain
Cat Cow or Segmented Cat Cow x 5 reps
Shinbox ER Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side

Jefferson Curl x 3-5 reps
Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
Pike Stretch to Back Roll x 5 reps
Bodyweight RDL x 10 reps

Thursday February 19, 2026

Week 2 Day 4 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: Functional Arms
The strength balance today focuses on the arms, which are often viewed as vanity muscles. Although this is true, the biceps and triceps are some of the most commonly used muscles in our day to day behavior. Why not look good and move well?
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Inchworm Push Up; 6-8 reps
Ring Row Hold; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
DB Floor Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 12 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 8-9
Working Set 2 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 10 @ 20X1
Working Set 3 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 12 @ 20X1
Working Set 4 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform MAX reps
Loading Note:
The rep scheme is written as a full pyramid when including the warmup sets. Each set should be challenging, aiming for RPE 8-9. Working Set 1 should increase your potential to execute even better on working sets 2-4. Aim for a 5-10% decrease in weight with each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Dual DB Bicep Curl; 10 reps @20X0

rest 30 sec
DB Overhead Tricep Extension; 10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Push Pull Sprint (12 min):
12min Continuous Clock
5 Shuttle Run
8-12 Wide Grip Deficit Push Up
10 Right Arm DB Snatch High Pull 50/35# or 35/20# (male/female)
10 Left Arm DB Snatch High Pull 50/35# or 35/20#
*Shuttle Run: Mark two points 10m apart. 1 rep = there and back.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
Straight Arm Shoulder Rotations; 10 reps/side
Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side

Friday February 20, 2026

Week 2 Day 5 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: Complementary Exercises
A lot of exercises are programmed to work nicely alongside a previous exercise. The Hip Thrust in Strength Balance today serves exactly that purpose. You'll spend a lot of time in the bottom position of the squat in Strength Intensity, and then do the exact opposite motion in Strength Balance with the Hip Thrust.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Long Step Walking Lunge; 6-8 reps/side
DB Swings; 10-15 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

1 1/4 Goblet Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

Control the first descent, come up 1/4 of the way, then control back down into the bottom using a subtle bounce to accelerate all the way back to the top. Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1 1/4 DB Hip Thrust; 10 reps
rest 30-60 sec
Bodyweight Donkey Calf Raise; 20-30 reps @10X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set for each movement to determine the starting weight. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7 and then increase weight each set.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12-15 min):
3 Sets @ high effort
16 Jump Lunge (8/side)
8 Single Arm KB Snatch Right 53/35# (male/female)
8 Single Arm KB Snatch Left 53/35#
6/leg Single Arm KB Front Rack Box Step Up 53/35#, 16-20"
16 Squat Jumps
rest 90sec between sets
Effort Note:
The suggested loads are only here as a reference point. I want you to be able to move smoothly through all your weight reps without having to take breaks or slow down. If that means you need to lighten up your weight, then please do so.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Heel Sits; 10 reps
Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Middle Split; 30 sec

Saturday February 21, 2026

Week 2 Day 6 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run/Bike/Row @ 75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 10 sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 10 reps/side (slow and controlled)
30 sec Superman Hold
Then 30 sec Run/Bike/Row @ 75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 10 sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 10 reps/side (slow and controlled)
15 L Crunches
Then 30 sec Run/Bike/Row @ 75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 10 sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Upper Body Mobility
Shoulder Circles x 10 reps/direction
Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 1 min/side
Childs Pose Reach Through x 1 min/side
Kneeling Triceps Stretch x 30 sec/side
Behind the Back Neck Stretch x 30 sec/side
Prone I x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone T x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone Y x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 3 reps
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Downdog to Updog x 5 reps

Sunday February 22, 2026

Week 2 Day 7 - Persist MINIMALIST
Overthinking Protein

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